

HASHKAMA



פרשת פנחס

יח' תמוז תשפ"ו

JULY 3, 2026

VOL 5786 ISSUE 40

WEEKLY

By Reb Gemini חכמה ב-אI תאמין?

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Morai v'rabbos, as you browse this bulletin while pretending to listen to the chazzan, let us discuss Parshas Pinchas. After the maggeifah, Hakadosh Baruch Hu commands Moshe to count Klal Yisroel by their mishpachos. Rashi, in Bamidbar 26:5, points out that Hakadosh Baruch Hu added the letter hei to the beginning of every family name and the letter yud to the end. Why? Rashi explains that the umos ha'olam mocked Klal Yisroel, claiming the Mitzriyim compromised their yichus during the bitter Golus. To silence these skeptics, Hakadosh Baruch Hu placed His Name — Yud and Hei — around the names of the mishpachos, testifying to their absolute taharas hamishpacha. If you try adding extra letters to your last name on the shul membership form, the gabbai will simply charge you a significantly larger building fund fee. But the profound truth here is that Hakadosh Baruch Hu personally vouched for the internal integrity of every bayis ne'eman b'Yisroel. The foundation of our tzibbur is not the grand, public displays of piety that happen right before an aliyah, but the quiet purity of our families when absolutely no one is looking.

However, possessing impeccable yichus is merely the baseline, which brings us directly to the second vital topic of our parsha. Once the klal is counted, Moshe Rabbeinu realizes his time is ending, and he petitions Hakadosh Baruch Hu for a new manhig. Moshe specifically requests a leader "asher yetzei lifneihem v'asher yavo lifneihem" (Bamidbar 27:17). Rashi, in Bamidbar 27:17, notes that a Jewish leader does not sit comfortably in his air-conditioned office while sending others to fight, unlike the kings of the umos ha'olam. A true Jewish manhig leads from the absolute front, never hiding behind his congregants. The connection between these two profound themes is incredibly striking. The hei and yud surrounding the mishpachos validate the private resilience of the Jewish home, but private virtue is utterly insufficient for national survival. You can have a shul filled with entirely choshuv mispallelim, but if everyone is waiting for someone else to step away from the shtender to actually take charge, absolutely nothing gets accomplished. The taharah of the klal established in the census requires the exhausting mesiras nefesh of true leadership to channel it into reality. Moshe understood that you cannot just rely on your impressive family tree; someone actually has to go out, face the midbar, and drag the tzibbur forward before the kiddush herring runs out.

The practical takeaway for all of us is rather simple, though almost universally avoided. We must simultaneously cultivate both the private and the public spheres of our lives. First, we have to ensure that our own mishpachos maintain the level of kedushah that Hakadosh Baruch Hu Himself would endorse, which means slightly less time complaining about shul politics and far more time actually focusing on chinuch habanim. Second, we cannot simply rest comfortably on our respectable yichus or safely hide in the back rows during davening. When a genuine community need arises, be the manhig who steps forward first. Do not just wait for the rabbi or the permanently stressed-out board members to magically handle every single crisis. Step up, take achrayus, and lead by example, even if your only actual reward in Olam Hazei is a thoroughly lukewarm piece of potato kugel.

News & Simchos!

Notice: Hashkama Update

This Week Shabbos, July 4th, Hashkama **relocates** to Rabbi Nussbaum's Shul (14 Sergio) at an uncompromising 7:00 AM.

What better way to privately mark a quarter-millennium of independence than voluntarily surrendering 15 minutes of sleep

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Shabbus Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm מנחה

6:58/8:14 pm (Early/Late) הדלקה

מנחה - קבלת שבת 7:00 pm

שקיעה 8:32 pm

עלות השחר (16.1/72) 3:40/4:17 am

נץ החמה 5:29 am

שחרית (14 Sergio) 7:00 am

ס"ז קריאת שמע 8:38/9:15 am

ס"ז תפילה 10:06/10:30 am

חצות היום 1:01 pm

מנחה גדולה (גרי"א) 1:38 pm

מנחה (14 Sergio) 1:45 pm

מנחה קטנה (גרי"א) 5:24 pm

פלג המנחה (גרי"א) 6:58 pm

שקיעה 8:32 pm

צה"כ ר' משה (8.5/50) 9:23/9:22 pm

מעריב (52) 9:24 pm

צה"כ (60/72) 9:32/9:44 pm



Next Week's Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm מנחה

6:57/8:12 pm (Early/Late) הדלקה

שקיעה 8:30 pm

שחרית (14 Sergio) 7:00 am

שקיעה 8:30 pm

מעריב (52) 9:22 pm

Parshah-ly Punny!

Riddle: Why did Hakadosh Baruch Hu specifically instruct Moshe Rabbeinu to physically press his hands upon Yehoshua when officially transferring the leadership of Klal Yisrael?

Answer: He needed to guarantee that the new manning was fully capable of handling the intense pressure.

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משל ונמשל ב-Al תאמין? By Reb Gemini

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Mashal: Morai v'rabbos, please pause your whispering about the kiddush sponsor for a moment so we can delve into the depths of Parshas Pinchas with a mashal. Imagine a prominent gvir in our very own kehilla, a true baal tzedakah who decides he wants to make an unparalleled splash. He bypasses the standard building fund completely and single-handedly sponsors a brand new, magnificent aron kodesh, hand-carved from imported mahogany, complete with a remote-controlled paroches and built-in LED lighting that practically blinds the chazzan during chazaras hashatz. The hachnasas sefer torah is a massive asifa with a catered seudah that rivals a chasunah in a five-star hotel. He is hoisted on the shoulders of the mispallelim, receiving endless kavod, shlishi on Shabbos, and a beautifully engraved plaque the size of a shtender. It is a moment of pure mesiras nefesh for the shul's aesthetics. However, after this monumental display of ahavas Hashem, this same gvir completely disappears from the daily minyan. When the gabbai desperately texts him on a Tuesday morning in November because they are stuck at nine men for shacharis, he suddenly has an urgent business meeting. He is perfectly willing to be the undisputed hero of the annual dinner, dropping staggering amounts of kesef to secure his legacy, but the grueling, unglamorous daily grind of simply showing up to answer amen yehei shmei rabba is apparently below his pay grade. He desires the flashy, dramatic moments of supreme spiritual triumph, but he entirely avoids the tedious, repetitive chiyuvim that actually keep the mosad functioning on a chilly winter morning.

Nimshal: The nimshal directly addresses the stark contrast presented in our parsha. We begin with the ultimate act of kanaus. Pinchas steps up in a moment of sheer chaos, risking his life to stop the maggeifah, and earns the extraordinary bracha of "bris shalom" (Bamidbar 25:12). It is the quintessential display of heroic mesiras nefesh. Yet, as the parsha concludes, Hakadosh Baruch Hu pivots to a completely different paradigm of avodas Hashem: the korban tamid. The Torah commands, "es hakeves ha'echad ta'aseh baboker v'es hakeves hasheni ta'aseh bein ha'arbayim" (Bamidbar 28:4). Day in and day out, rain or shine, weekday or Yom Tov, this standard, unexciting sheep is brought on the mizbeach. There is a famous Midrash, cited in the hakdamah to Ein Yaakov, where the chachamim debate the most encompassing pasuk in the entire Torah. Ben Zoma suggests the pasuk of Shema Yisroel. Ben Nannas argues for "v'ahavta l'reiacha kamocha" (Vayikra 19:18). But Shimon ben Pazzai declares that the pasuk of "es hakeves ha'echad" is the greatest klal gadol b'Torah, and the halacha follows him. Why? Because while Pinchas's dramatic kanaus was necessary for that specific, disastrous moment, a Yiddishe neshama cannot survive strictly on adrenaline and crisis management. Hakadosh Baruch Hu values the kvius of the korban tamid over the flash of the spear. The true test of a Litvish yid is not whether he can summon the courage to yell at the gabbai over a perceived slight to his kavod, but whether he can maintain an unbreakable kvius itim l'Torah after a completely exhausting day at the office. The ribbono shel olam is telling us that the foundation of our ruchniyus is built on the unrelenting, often boring consistency of our daily tefillos and limud hatorah, far more than our occasional bursts of spiritual heroism.

Practical Takeaway: The practical takeaway for our kehilla is that we need to drastically reevaluate our spiritual priorities and stop waiting for our own personal Pinchas moment. We all love the inspiration of Neilah, the emotional high of a kumtitz, or the immense satisfaction of dramatically winning a machlokes in halacha. However, Hakadosh Baruch Hu is actively demanding the korban tamid from us. Your tachlis is found in waking up at an ungodly hour for the daf yomi shiur, even when the maggid shiur is discussing the most incomprehensible sugya in Eruvin and the shul's coffee tastes like repurposed cardboard. It means showing up for mincha-maariv exactly on time, not sauntering in right as the tzibbur is reaching shmoneh esrei. True avodas Hashem is fundamentally about the daily grind, the stubborn hasmadah of putting one foot in front of the other in the midbar of our mundane lives. So, please, leave the dramatic zealotry to Pinchas, skip the unnecessary heroics, and simply try to make it to shacharis before the chazzan has already reached yishtabach.

GOOD SHABBUS!